



Fastest selling PC game

Diablo III has set a record for the fastest selling PC game to date.
<http://dgit.in/KFRPQd>

Now create objects using light

An high definition 3D printer called B9Creator lets you to create objects using light
<http://dgit.in/KjOLKK>

Panasonic pair felt well made, almost metallic thanks to the use of high grade plastic and the finish. The SZ-7 particularly caught our interest, being slimmest of the lot. And then there was the Samsung, which seemed too plastic for our taste, but the interesting aspect about the build is the solid metal ring around its lens. This made the camera's front very heavy.

PERFORMANCE

The first thing we did was setup a tripod and fire off the cameras aimed at a bush, zoomed in at their maximum focal length. The process of zooming was smooth and paced comfortably; the cameras locked focus quickly and on the intended part of the scene and even the exposures were more or less spot on. However, when we viewed the images on our monitor at 100 per cent, we noticed severe JPEG artifacts. Sadly, we observed this behavior in every single camera we tested

to macro focusing mode. Looking at the images, we can say that the Leica lens is adding some serious good optics to the Panasonic cameras in our test. While the Nikons and the Samsung WB150F showed noticeable distortion at minimum focusing distance, along with what we'd consider lack of sharpness, both the DMC-TZ25 and the DMC SZ-7 performed exceptionally. When it came to ISO performance, all cameras delivered noise free images in our test, but due to the noise reduction, there was a severe loss in detail, evident even at ISO 400, but quite pronounced at ISO 1600 and above. While all the cameras in our test went up to ISO 6400, the Panasonic DMC-TZ25 and the Samsung WB150F retained ISO 3200 as their highest, a logical choice seeing as how their performance tops out at that level.

The clear winner here was the Panasonic DMC-TZ25, with maximum detail retention at high ISOs. The Nikon S8200 scored the same amount as the TZ25, but that was due to a higher lower ISO score, but at higher ISOs, the Panasonic definitely

shines. In the overall image sharpness department, the results were again in favor of the Panasonic, with the Leica lens retaining great sharpness at the center and the edges of the scene better than any other camera in the bracket.

While most of them managed near excellent center



Panasonic DMC-SZ7

sharpness, it's the edges where the Panasonic outshone everyone else.

VERDICT

The Panasonic SZ7 wins our hearts as the "Best Buy". The slightly more expensive Panasonic DMC-TZ25 is our "Editor's Pick", offering the best performance in the category. So if you're someone who's willing to spend a little extra, then this is the best you can get under ₹16k.

ABOVE ₹16,000

We pit cameras ranging from ₹16,999 to ₹22,990 and we sure got some interesting results. With the cost factor rising, it is only natural that our expectations from these higher end travel zooms increase as well.

FEATURES AND DESIGN

At the heart of a camera lies the imaging sensor, and all these cameras employ the newly developed Back-Illuminated Sensors to produce noise free images even at higher ISOs. However, they all most have a differing megapixel count, with Sony's HX20V and HX10V boasting an 18-megapixel sensor and Canon SX260HS and SX240HS with a modest (and lowest) 14-megapixel ticker. The Nikons and Panasonics have

stuck to a 16-megapixel sensor. We have always asserted that a larger megapixel count doesn't necessarily mean better image quality, especially since the size of the sensor in a point-and-shoot is extremely small. Fitting too many pixels into such a tight space does lead to some degradation in quality, but the new BSI sensors (or Back Side Illuminated) have been designed specially to deal with that problem. Sort of. In the optical zoom department, 20X seems to be the standard with Canon SX260HS, SX40HS, Sony HX20V and Panasonic DMC-TZ30 sharing that number.

The Nikon S9200, S9300 and the Sony HX10V settle in at a comfortable 18X. What's nice about the modern day travel zoom is the fact that image stabilization that used to be once a feature restricted ONLY to very expensive DSLR lenses, is now finding itself being implemented in almost every point-and-shoot. Sony and Panasonic's DSLRs have a sensor shift based stabilization system, yet, their travel zooms are using the lens-shift system of stabilization. An interesting addition to the cameras in this bracket is the addition of built-in GPS chips, for easy geotagging of your images. You can even find dedicated image processing chips in these cameras, like Canon's Digic 5 processor, or Nikon's Exceed or Panasonic's Venus Engine that help with cleaning up the raw information from the sensor and writing it into a nice, well toned image onto your SD card. These chips are also the reason manufacturers have been able to infuse their cameras with insane burst modes.

ERGONOMICS

From all that we have held, we can safely conclude that



Panasonic DMC-TZ30

in this category. Image quality at the telephoto end does take a serious hit.

Macro photography is something that we can say for sure that everyone with a point-and-shoot has tried to do. We found ourselves a nice little flower and set our cameras